
Core Field Manual

Part 2 Basic Training



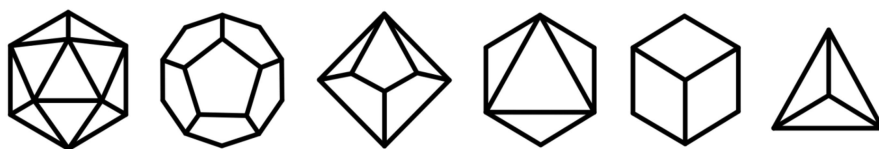


Dice

The essential tools of any player and GM is a standard set of dice, including a 20-sided die, a 12-sided die, a 10-sided die, and several 4 and 6-sided dice. In this manual, these dice will be referred to in a “XdY” form, where **X** is the number of dice and **Y** is the type. So 1d12 means one 12-sided die, 6d4 represents six 4-sided dice, and “d20” refers to the general concept of a 20-sided die.

Some dice in this game are uncommon such as a d5 and a d16. It is recommended to use a computer to roll these dice, however there are workarounds with physical dice.

- For d5: roll 1d6 and reroll if you land on 6
- For d16: use the formula “1d4×4 + 1d4 - 4” or alternatively, roll 1d20 and reroll anything above a 16



Initiative

Initiative describes the order in which everyone takes their Turn. To establish this order, everyone must roll for Initiative with a Reflex Check (1d20 + Reflex). The order of Initiative is the highest to lowest value rolls, and the GM can determine how to break ties.

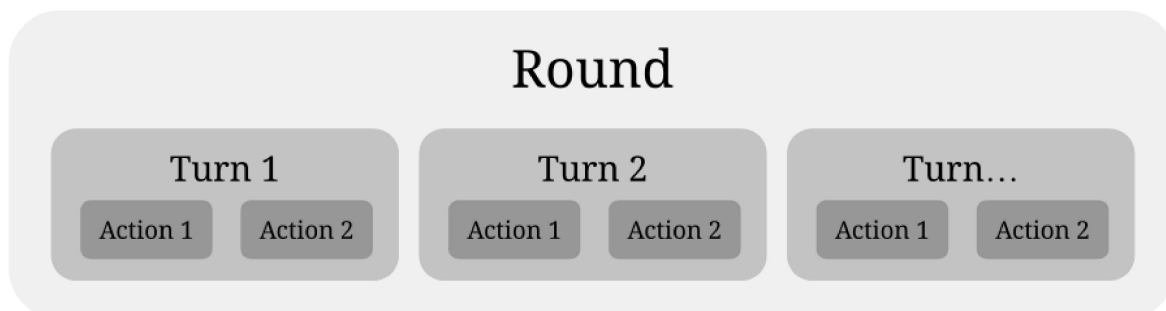
An Initiative roll can be triggered at any time by the GM, who may use it out of combat to add structure to rollplay, before battle in anticipation of combat, or at the very moment fighting starts.

Additionally, the GM can choose to add an Action Zero which occurs just prior to the Initiative roll. While Action Zero may normally look like an initiator making a single attack such as the first swing of a bar fight or first contact in the battlefield, the GM can allow multiple parties an Action Zero such as during an ambush, or even allow defenders a Reaction contest like in a cowboy showdown. Ultimately, the ways a fight can kick off are inherently unpredictable and thus the moment before the Initiative roll is at the discretion of the GM.

Action Economy

Rounds, Turns, Actions, & Reactions is how everyone in the game interacts with the world around them. Everyone has two Actions per Turn and a single Turn per Round, the order of which is determined by Initiative.

At any point in a Round, you may delay your Turn to happen before or after a friendly teammate who is after you in the Turn order. This change is permanent for the remainder of the combat. There are also **Reactions**, which are a special type of Action that occur outside of the player's Turn, but only by way of specific triggers covered in the Reaction rules.



Every significant interaction a soldier has with the world is an Action. At the discretion of the GM, the length of an Action should represent somewhere between 3 and 10 seconds. All Actions that are not trivial to accomplish, as outlined by this Field Manual or determined by the GM, are called a **Check** and will require a d20 + relevant Ability Score roll to resolve the outcome.

The goal of this d20 roll is to meet or exceed a DC value. In general, a DC of 1-5 is considered a modest task with a minor risk of failure. A DC 6-12 is a challenge that can be a tossup depending on how strong the relevant Ability Score is. A DC 13-17 is a true test of ability and can be risky even for a skilled soldier. Anything DC 18 and beyond represents true challenges and should only be undertaken when armed with significant advantages or by the truly desperate.

To help, Checks will have modifiers a player can add. Some types of Checks like To-Hit will have specific rules; however others may not be specifically mentioned in this Field Manual, such as attempting to climb a rock or recon an area. Your modifier will be an Ability Score determined by the GM, and the Check will have a DC deemed appropriate by the GM. Beware, modifiers can be negative if you are attempting a Check under non-ideal conditions.

Movement

Movement on the battlefield is key to accomplishing objectives and staying alive. The normal map of a Cannon Fodder game is made up of Spaces where moving in the Cardinal Directions (including diagonals) counts as moving 1 Space. At the discretion of the GM, each Space should represent an area of somewhere between 5x5 feet to 5x5 yards.

The player can use a Movement Action to traverse up to their movement speed in that Action, such as crossing a field, climbing a hill, or ascending a ladder. **A player's base movement is 5 Spaces per Action** which can be broken up before and after a subsequent Action, such as moving 3 squares to take a shot and then 2 Squares back for cover.

Your movement speed can change based on other factors such as stances, suppression, abilities, and more. These will be discussed later in the manual.

You can also choose to limit your speed to 3 Spaces per Action to **Creep**. Creeping gives you the ability to stealth and react to Held Reactions. Refer to the Reaction and Stealth sections.



“Anyone who has ever looked into the glazed eyes of a soldier dying on the battlefield will think hard before starting a war.”
- Otto von Bismarck

